

How to search for text

- **/text:** Searches downward for text (text can contain spaces or characters with special meanings)
- **?text:** Searches upward for text
- **n:** Re-performs the last search in the same direction
- **N:** Re-performs the last search in the opposite direction
- **F char:** Searches forward for a character on the current line
- **B char:** Searches backward for a character on the current line
- **;** : Repeats last character search in the same direction
- **%** : Finds the matching brackets ((), {}, or [])

How to save the file and exit VI after editing

You have to be in command mode to exit VI. Use the Escape key to switch to command mode if you are not in it.

Note: For commands that begin with a colon (:), you have to press Return after the command.

Saving and exiting commands

- **:q:** Quit (it will quit, only if no changes are made)
- **q!:** Lets you quit without saving any changes
- **:wq:** Write to the file, and then quit (i.e., save and exit)
- **ZZ:** Will save the changes and quit VI (this is the easiest way to exit VI)
- **:w fileName:** Saves the file as the defined filename
- **w! fileName:** Overwrite as per the defined filename (i.e., forced save)

Conclusion

VI being the default editor available on all varieties of the Unix system, learning how to operate this text editor becomes crucial and profitable in the long run. Following are some key highlights from this crash course:

- The VI editor is quite user-friendly, and learning it is not too difficult.
- Basics are always important. Get a good understanding of all the basic commands to learn this text editor effectively and quickly.
- The scope of learning in this software is unlimited. This course mainly includes the basic commands that you need to know to master using this text editor. You need to explore it more to completely master it. 